



Predators and prey

SOME OCEAN ANIMALS are herbivores (plant-eaters) from certain fish nibbling seaweeds on coral reefs to dugongs chewing seagrasses. There are also many carnivores (meat-eaters) in the ocean. Some, such as blue sharks and barracuda, are swift hunters, while others, such as anglerfish and sea anemones, set traps for their prey waiting with snapping jaws or stinging tentacles respectively. Many animals strain food out of the water from the humble sea fan to giant baleen whales. Seabirds also find their meals in the ocean diving for a beakful of prey. Some ocean animals are omnivores—they eat both plants and animals.

FANG FACE

The wolf fish has strong, fanglike teeth for crunching through the hard shells of crabs, sea urchins, and mussels. As the front set are worn down each year, or broken, they are replaced by a new set which grow in behind the old teeth. Wolf fish live in cool, deep, northern waters where they lurk in rocky holes.

Tough, wrinkled skin helps protect wolf fish living near the seabed



Tiny prey caught in mucus



COOPERATIVE FEEDING

Humpback whales herd shoals of fish by letting out bubbles as they swim around them. Opening their mouths wide to gulp in food and water, they retain fish but expel water through sievelike baleen plates in their mouths.

CAUGHT BY SLIME

Unlike many jellyfish that trap prey with their stinging tentacles, common jellyfish catch small drifting animals (plankton) in sticky slime (mucus) produced by the bell. The four fleshy arms beneath the bell collect up the food-laden slime and tiny hairlike cilia channel it into the mouth.



Dorsal fin runs along entire length of body

Crooked, yellow fanglike teeth

Pectoral fin

